James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Marketing leader who has built growth and product marketing functions from scratch for fintech and SaaS companies since 2018, across Africa, North America and Europe. I set the positioning, build the acquisition and lifecycle engine, hire and run the people and agencies behind it, and report spend against real revenue. My fintech work includes leading growth and marketing at Bujeti (YC W23) and product marketing at Bento Africa across four countries. I have sold to businesses and to consumers in the same career, and I run my own media business read mostly by Nigerians at home and in the US diaspora. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/kredete.

Selected Achievements:

- Generated **1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months** as Head of Growth and Marketing at Bujeti, a fintech spend management platform. New B2B customers grew **500% in Q1 2024**, and lifecycle redesign cut churn by **10%**.
- Launched the Cecure Intelligence Academy across **Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda and Angola**: 20,000+ community members and 10,000+ users in the first cohort at under **$0.50 customer acquisition cost**, alongside **$3.4M in open B2B deal value**.
- Repositioned Reform for a new buyer: **34% lift in trial activation**, and a launch framework that lifted new feature adoption **26%** within 90 days.
- Built a paid-acquisition system that judges campaigns on backend sales instead of ad-platform reports. It caught Meta cross-crediting sales between products and now runs client campaigns, including a consumer brand held at about **8x return on ad spend** for five years.
- Grew the Marketing In Action newsletter to **5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate**. Named one of Africa's Top 20 Marketing Leaders (APMP 2025).

KEY SKILLS

Strategy: Brand & Narrative Strategy, Positioning & Messaging, Go-to-Market & Launch Planning, B2B & B2C Acquisition Strategy, Market Expansion & Localization, Customer Segmentation, Competitive Intelligence, Marketing Budget Allocation, Thought Leadership

Execution: Paid Social & Search, Lifecycle & CRM Programs, SEO & Content Engines, Partnerships & Events, Pipeline & Lead Scoring, Attribution & CAC Reporting, Agency & Contractor Management, Team Building

Tools: GA4, Looker Studio, Google Tag Manager, Meta & TikTok Ads, Google Ads, HubSpot, Brevo, Mixpanel, Webflow, Claude Code, n8n

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (newsletter, academy and marketing services, Nigeria, US, UK)

- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate and 11% click-through rate, read mainly in Nigeria (46%) and the US (32%).
- Built a paid-acquisition operating system across seven ad platforms that reconciles platform-reported conversions against backend sales; it isolated a checkout drop-off on a cold campaign that ad data had blamed on creative.
- Run a paid-ads services business with three specialists delivering client work through a documented handoff, review and reporting system.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
Reform (SaaS, MarTech, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy)

- Repositioned the product around lead conversion: 34% lift in trial activation and 19% more decision-stage leads from competitor pages.
- Launched the Pro Plan Free Trial across web, email and in-app: 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion.
- Built the Feature Launch Plan Framework: 26% lift in new feature adoption within 90 days.
- Built an AI-assisted SEO engine and integration pages: 48% rise in non-branded organic traffic.
- Built Reform's partner program on PartnerStack from scratch: recruiting, incentives, tracking and swipe assets.

GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, revenue funnel optimization service provider)

- Built a quarterly demand generation roadmap across outbound, lifecycle and paid: 40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads.
- Designed a cross-brand measurement stack (GA4, Looker Studio, Lightdash, HubSpot) that cut reporting time 50%.
- Led the FunnelEnvy rebrand: visual identity, brand style guide and sales deck system. Managed an outsourced content agency.

GTM & Product Marketing Consultant | Komfot Health | Nov 2025 – Mar 2026
Komfot Health (B2C and B2B2C digital health, Nigeria, Rwanda, Benin)

- Defined the go-to-market structure for three countries and adapted positioning and messaging to legal and cultural limits in each market.
- Audited seven acquisition channels and built the partnership framework for lead flow.

Head of Inbound Marketing & SEO | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024
Distrobird (sales engagement SaaS, US)

- Led a content team of five writers and two editors and ranked for 3,000+ competitive keywords in three months.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024
Bujeti (YC W23, SaaS, fintech spend and expense management, Nigeria)

- Built the growth function across product marketing, lifecycle, SEO, events and partnerships.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months (431 in Q4 2023, 900 in Q1 2024) and grew new B2B customers 500% in Q1 2024.
- Improved landing page conversion by 20% and product conversion by 18%; 200+ marketing qualified leads came from events and partnerships.
- Redesigned lifecycle email and in-app flows: 20% higher engagement and 10% lower churn.

Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023
Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, UK and Sub-Saharan Africa)

- Progressed from Sales Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer, running revenue operations and cross-functional GTM teams.
- Launched the CIL Academy across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda and Angola: 20,000+ community members and 10,000+ users in the first cohort at under $0.50 customer acquisition cost.
- Generated 1,646 marketing qualified leads, 406 sales qualified leads and 629 demos: $326K in sales velocity and $3.4M in open deal value.
- Ran paid campaigns at 2-3x return on ad spend on $1.5K to $15K monthly budgets, plus partnerships with AWS, Google and Microsoft.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022
B2B, SaaS, fintech, consumer brands and service businesses

- Product Marketing Manager at Bento Africa (payroll and HR fintech across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya and Rwanda): 50% more sales qualified leads and 25% higher sales conversion from lead scoring and lifecycle nurture programs.
- Marketing & Growth Advisor at JegzFits Leatherworks (consumer brand, Nigeria, 2021 to present): Meta and TikTok acquisition held at about 8x return on ad spend as spend grew.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- **Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0